

Department of Veterans Affairs

Memorandum

Date: February 4, 2026

From: Ron Kendall PharmD & Elizabeth Scruggs-Wodkowski MD
(Antimicrobial Stewardship Program Co-Leaders)

Subj: Oracle EHRM Infection PowerPlans

To: All Providers and Residents

Providing local, facility-specific clinical guidance for common infectious syndromes is a core strategy for hospital antimicrobial stewardship programs. Facility guidelines are developed utilizing local epidemiology, antimicrobial resistance patterns, and formulary restrictions to best serve the facility's patient population.

Oracle EHRM utilizes "Infection Power Plans" which are nationally developed clinical guidelines embedded within the EMR and accessible to inpatient, ER, and outpatient clinicians. These power plans are created at the national level and are identical across the VA. Individual antimicrobial stewardship programs are unable to customize, adapt, or remove them to align with facility level antimicrobial stewardship workflows and initiatives.

The AAVA Antimicrobial Stewardship Program recommends that clinicians **avoid** use of embedded Infection Power Plans, which may not reflect local epidemiology, resistance patterns, patient population, or formulary considerations. Guidance on local antimicrobial resistance, restricted antimicrobials, and clinical guidance can be found on the AAVA Antimicrobial Stewardship SharePoint site at:

<https://dvagov.sharepoint.com/sites/vhaannpharm/SitePages/Antimicrobial-Stewardship.aspx>

ID attendings, ID fellows, and the ID pharmacist are authorized to approve the use of restricted antimicrobials and can provide additional guidance on appropriate antimicrobial selection. The ID fellow can be reached at pager 3010 or office phone 734-845-5806. The ID pharmacist, Dr. Ron Kendall, can be reached at office phone 734-845-5829 or by Microsoft Team message. Dr. Scruggs-Wodkowski can be reached at office phone 734-222-6026 or by Microsoft Team message.